

Heave

2026, Saïd Galdseid, <https://boardgamegeek.com/thread/3638650>

The game is played on an initially empty square board, say 11x11.

Definitions:

- A **stack** is one or more pieces of the same color placed in the same cell.
- The **height** of a stack is the number of pieces it contains, which is the same as the number of all adjacent friendly stacks [no matter if they are alive or dead, see below].
- A **group** is a maximal set of connected stacks of the same color and height. There are no isolated stacks, as height 0 stacks do not exist.
- A **dead group** is a group adjacent to an enemy group of greater height; otherwise, it is a *live group*. A group is also **alive** if it is adjacent to an enemy group of greater height that is itself dead.

Black plays first, and then players alternate. On your turn, perform one of the following actions:

- *Place* two friendly stacks simultaneously on two empty cells adjacent to each other, provided that neither of them is adjacent to any existing friendly stacks.
- *Place* exactly one stack of your color on an empty cell adjacent to at least one friendly stack.
- *Pass* your turn if you cannot make a placement; otherwise, passing is not allowed.

Goal. The game ends when the board is completely full. The player with the highest score wins, which is calculated as the sum of the live stacks of their color plus the dead stacks of the opposing color.

To balance the game, before starting, the first player places two Black stacks simultaneously on two empty cells adjacent to each other, and the second player chooses a side.

[BGG description]

